MEBEVERINE

IBS

20 min before meals

CHEMICAL NAME 4-[ethyl[1-(4-methoxyphenyl)propan-2-yl]amino]butyl 3,4-dimethoxybenzoate (hydrochloride)

CLASS Musculotropic antispasmodic (direct smooth-muscle relaxant)

TRADE NAMES Colofac · Duspatalin · Duspatal

THERAPEUTIC USES / INDICATIONS

- Irritable bowel syndrome (abdominal pain, cramps, bloating).
- GI spasm secondary to organic disease.

ADMINISTRATION

- **PO** tablets 20 minutes before meals; MR capsules twice daily, swallowed whole.

DOSAGES

- **Adult & ≥10 yr:** 135 mg three times daily before meals, or MR 200 mg twice daily.
- Reduce gradually once symptoms controlled.

PHARMACOKINETICS

- **Onset:** 15 min. **Duration:** 4–6 h (MR 12 h).
- Rapid first-pass hydrolysis by esterases.
- Excreted in urine. **t½:** ~2.5 h (metabolites).

PHARMACODYNAMICS

- Direct action on **GI smooth muscle** (blocks Na^+ channels, ↓ Ca^{2+} influx) → relieves spasm without affecting normal motility.
- No anticholinergic side effects.

SIDE & ADVERSE EFFECTS

SIDE EFFECTS (COMMON)

- Rash, urticaria (rare).
- Dizziness.
- Dyspepsia.

ADVERSE EFFECTS (SERIOUS)

- Angioedema, anaphylaxis (rare).

CONTRAINDICATIONS & CAUTIONS

- Hypersensitivity.
- Paralytic ileus.
- Porphyria.

KEY INTERACTIONS

- No clinically significant interactions.

NURSING MANAGEMENT

- Assess pain pattern, bowel habit.
- Screen for red flags (weight loss, rectal bleeding, age >50 new symptoms, anaemia).

PATIENT EDUCATION

- Take 20 minutes before meals.
- Dietary changes (low FODMAP, regular meals) and stress management help IBS.
- Seek review for weight loss, blood in stools or night-time symptoms.

KEY POINTS

- Direct GI smooth-muscle antispasmodic.
- No anticholinergic effects.
- IBS; 135 mg TDS before meals.
- Well tolerated.